

The Plant Between Sun and Moon

"Sun" and "moon" are active in every plant. The colour green, as the presence of a color, is already an expression of the "Sun"'s influence. Obviously, every plant also expresses the quality of what we call "Moon," since it originates from the water element. Every plant, no matter how dry, depends on the presence of water.

The sun's influence is particularly evident in the upright and straight stem, which is as if "attracted" by the sun. The lunar influence is evident in horizontal, often winding growth. Both signs are immediately clear if we remember the difference between *standing* during the day and *lying down* at night. Now, imagine a plant with roots and a leafy stem. Experience how flower buds form at the top of the shoots, how they open to the sun, fade, and develop into fruits with seeds. Each of the areas essentially corresponds to these forces (read from bottom to top):

- (Seed) – Saturn
- (Fruit) – Jupiter
- (Flower, faded) – Mars • (Flower) – Sun
- (Bud) – Venus
- (Seedling, leaf area) – Mercury
- (Root) – Moon, Saturn

This is a first, general orientation. I will now examine each of the stages first in its typical expression and then as a special case. By "special case" I mean an exaggeration of the usual. An example: Typically, the salt principle (minerals = earth) predominates in the root area, while the sulfur principle (essential oils, color = fire) predominates in the flower area. In special cases, for example, a red color and/or essential oils appear as fiery expressions in the root (e.g. elecampane, angelica). When the fire element extends that far down, it is something very special and thus says something essential about the plant. Now let's consider the plant in space and time.

Roots - Realm of the Moon

The subterranean realm corresponds to the moon and the earth. The polarity between "sun" and "moon" is simple: What is above the ground is actually illuminated by the sun. What remains hidden in the earth remains unconscious and thus in the realm of the moon. This is where the heavier elements water and earth are present.



(Salomon's Seal: The white root forms an underground node every year and thus creeps very slowly and almost unnoticed in the soil.)

The roots absorb the vital water ("Moon") as well as mineral salts ("Saturn," salt principle). Saturn and the Moon, Earth and the Moon, are the rulers of the "non-sun" realm. Digging roots is always radical (from *radix* meaning root). Let's now exaggerate this typical example: What living being, as a whole, would be like a root and/or in the dark? Clearly, these are creatures that live hidden in water, in the forest, or in the earth. We could very generally include mushrooms, whose mycelium grows deep in moist soil or in rotting wood. But some plants that are rounded like a root ball, such as mistletoe, lemon balm, or chickweed, can also tell us something along these lines. Furthermore, forest-dwelling plants are significantly less known than plants of the meadows. This, too, is an indication of "non-sun-being", being in the shadow of our consciousness. In the forest, warmth and light are often repressed; depending on the type of forest, we are almost in a damp, and dark atmosphere.

What Leaf and Stem reveal

The leaf is generally an expression of Mercury. The leaf, as the central organ of the green plant, allows for a great variety of shapes. It is a very interesting field of activity to examine the individual leaf for its elemental forces, e.g., whether it is more fiery or watery. The highest fiery power unfolds in the leaves of rosemary and conifers (pine, fir). Rosemary has the highest essential oil content in its needle-shaped leaves (but not in the flowers!). Rosemary looks like a miniature conifer. Most conifers are rich in essential oils and produce resins (high and low sulfur). An important exception is the yew.

The leaf shape, which is related to elements air and water, is rather narrow (grasses, lilies). But the oval-egg-shaped leaves of hyssop or St. John's wort also belong in this category. St. John's wort is not truly fiery in its leaves, but rather "luminous." The dried St. John's wort, however, then displays "needles" again, similar to those observed in rosemary.

I invite you to experience and observe nature as openly and playfully as a child, and not to shy away from such simple observations. Heart- and kidney-shaped plants indicate plants that are more inclined towards water and the earth (linden tree). Circular leaves are quite seldom. They show a clear relationship with

water (water lilies, Indian cress = *Tropaeolum*). The otherwise fiery Indian cress is moist in every part, even the unripe seed is full of water.

What if the entire plant is dominated by the leaf? This is often the case with creeping and climbing cucumber plants and field bindweed (*Convolvulus*). Jiaogulan ("herb of immortality") is also a telling example: This plant is all leaf and stem.

The stem of the plant, together with the leaf, forms a functional unit. This is the middle area. The stem can rise vertically toward the sun (or be attracted by it) or lie horizontally, hidden in the earth. Here, the great polarity of "sun" and "moon" is evident: The towering, fiery stem of arnica or the tough, straight stem of St. John's wort testify to solar power. The creeping, subterranean shoot of the forest-dwelling Solomon's seal indicates the lunar-Mercurial nature of its essence. The stem generally exhibits a fiery force that can be described as "counteracting fire" and is often recognizable as a red color. It is the fire that "strikes back" from the earth: an image of rising up against resistance, or of the shoot that breaks through the asphalt and pushes upwards. This is a force that is so important in grain. It's just a pity that today, out of convenience, we plant such low-growing wheat and rye varieties.

The Flower in Time

The flower is the place where you can tell the relationship a plant has with the "sun." Every flower undergoes a process in time. The bud precedes the main flowering, the open flower. The faded flower often drops its petals, sometimes its sepals as well. The stamens also dry up, while only the carpels swell. The process of bud, blossom, and fruit with seed can be described as a sequence of the planetary forces of Venus, the Sun, Mars, Jupiter, and Saturn.

The bud typically corresponds to the Venus stage; the open flower to the Sun; the faded (burnt) flower to Mars; the swelling fruit to Jupiter; and the seed to the Saturn stage. What does it indicate when, in some flowers, only the bud appears pink (e.g., daisies) or when the budding flowers are more intensely coloured than the open ones (e.g. many roses)?

Let's consider now plants that appear like buds as a whole: A plant like a bud is a plant like a swelling life, preparing to bloom. Yarrow immediately comes to mind. It swells in spring as wonderfully as a fountain; later, however, a gray veil (of Saturn) covers it, and its leaves become pointed and hard. Lemon balm also swells in a fresh, vibrant green, exuding a pleasant fragrance that suggests Venusian power. It only becomes hard and less attractive after flowering.

The plant's climax is flowering. This is the realm of the sun. A plant that is entirely in flower is one with a strong solar influence. St. John's wort is a good example. Indeed, it is only truly "St. John's wort" when it is in flower. Arnica, too, is only recognisable as such by most people when it is in flower. Before it blooms, many walk past it without noticing that arnica is growing right there. Only when in bloom does it fully reveal its beingness. Other plants indicate their remoteness from the sun or their lunar influence by blooming at night (Queen of the Night, *Datura*). Plants that bloom in winter are even more strongly influenced by Saturn (Christmas rose).

In the burnt and dried out blossoms I see the forces of Mars: The petals have fallen off, the stamens withered. The young fruits gradually emerge. Fire has to burn away that which no longer is needed. With the poppy plant, this happens quickly: One petal after another falls, and the young seed capsule with the dried stamens stands.



(Pictured here is a bud and three blackberry blossoms with withered stamens. The petals have already fallen off.)

Mars power always indicates a fiery effect. The subsequent fruit and seed formation truly requires this solar-fiery force, especially for essence and seed formation.

This Mars state taken to an extreme corresponds to a plant that looks like a faded blossom. Which plants look burnt or dried out? These are plants with hard, dead parts, with thorns and spines, such as barberry or blackberry vines.

The fruit lies within the sphere of influence of Jupiter. Even the actual astronomical size of this gas giant can easily be mentally connected to the swelling of the fruit. The typical characteristics of a fruit are very familiar to us, as fruits constitute an important part of our diet: apples, pears, oranges, plums, but also eggplant, pumpkin, tomatoes, and zucchini are fruits. What they all have in common is that they swell due to the water present and more or less approach a spherical shape. They also need the sun to develop color, aroma, and oils. Both the sun and the moon are present here - this is typical for Jupiter.

A special case is when the fruit character is already recognizable in the early stages. This then indicates that this plant entity is dealing very intensively with Jupiter forces. This is the case with many thistles: their buds already look like fruit.



The flowering milk thistle and the greater burdock also clearly show their fruit even when budding or flowering. Mars forces also play a role here.

Which plant is overall like a fruit, plump, large, and swollen? This is a plant that takes up a lot of space. Milk thistle immediately comes to mind, along with other stately plants, especially trees like the walnut tree or the oak. All of the above are also very nutritious: acorns, walnuts, and the oil-rich seeds of thistles. The seed lies in the area of barren Saturn, which brings us to the end of the fiery development. And yet: Inside the hard, small seed lies a white, soft substance, a "slime," ready to begin the cycle anew.

Some Correspondances:

Sun – Blossom, Warmth, Color, Annual Cycle
 Moon – Root Space, Moisture, Decay
 Saturn – Seed (Root), Cold, Dry Earth, Endurance
 Mars – Thorns, Fire, Heat, Rhythm
 Venus – Buds, Coolness, Moisture
 Mercury – Leaf, Winding, and Tendrils
 Jupiter – Fruit, Branches, Space

Hardness, blackness, or grayness, and especially permanence, are all signs of Saturn. Strong Saturn power often manifests itself in reduced leaves, buds, flowers, and fruits. Saturn signifies dry earth. And it is precisely in this earth that some seeds can lie and endure for a very, very long time. As soon as the connection with the lunar force (water) is established, the seed bursts open, and the green is reborn. Some seeds have the property of swelling. This is particularly evident in the case of basil and chia sage: as soon as the black seeds are watered, they turn gray and look moldy. There is a swelling layer on the outside of the seed that retains moisture to promote germination.

Conclusion and Outlook

Since *all seven* planetary forces are present *in every* plant, I invite you to look closely and with attention. In my understanding, the seven archetypes can only be understood more deeply in connection with the 5th and 3rd levels, meaning the three principles (sulfur, mercury, salt) and the elemental forces (earth, water, fire, air, ether). This table is but an invitation to be curious about each level of the force network in more detail:

Planetary Forces, Principles, and Elemental Forces

Planetary Force	Principle	Elemental Force
Sun	Sulfur	
Moon	Mercury	
Saturn	Salt	Earth
Mars		Fire
Venus		Water
Mercury		Air
Jupiter		Ether

*"Nature is never static -
 but always fresh and new."*

Thank you for your attention.
 Arbor Vitae, Sept. 21st 2025